



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's plan a luncheon!



Learning Outcome

Use expressions about relationships and feelings in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can exchange opinions.
- I can discuss eating habits.
- I can change topics in a conversation.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you succeeded at work?
- What did you do to celebrate?





Let's Explore!

Janet and Miranda want to celebrate their new **partnership*** with Holly's. What are they planning?

* A "partnership" refers to being in a business relationship with another organization.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Good news Miranda! Holly's has accepted the partnership with Polygon.
Miranda: Fantastic! We've been anticipating this. You weren't taken by surprise, were you?
Janet: No, I could sense Farmani was leaning our way.
Miranda: I felt that as soon as he gave us the extension. That was a strong indication, if you ask me.
Janet: I think you really persuaded him.
Miranda: We all did! Congratulations!
Janet: Everyone's worked hard. On that note, how do you want to celebrate this? Perhaps with a luncheon?
Miranda: I must say I like the idea. Should I look into a caterer?
Janet: Yes. To be honest, you're good at that. By the way, what kind of diets do people follow?
Miranda: We have a few vegans and vegetarians. I could be wrong, but we have some employees on a high protein diet, so we need meat as well.
Janet: How about you?
Miranda: I'm on a gluten-free, low-fat, and low-sodium diet.
Janet: Sounds complicated. But, we haven't mentioned dessert. How do you feel about including some chocolate?
Miranda: Of course! I see chocolate on your desk everyday.
Janet: I know. I'm addicted to it. Oh that reminds me, we should get a cake!
Miranda: Speaking of sweets, I'll bring us some coffees before we spend some time discussing where to go from here. How do you take yours?
Janet: I take two creams and no sugar. Thanks Miranda.





Let's Practice!

Does Janet think Farmani was leaning their way*?

* To "lean your way" means someone is interested in something you have proposed.

Instructions: Mark all the correct answers. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) Select all the sentences that ask for an opinion.

- ☐ I knew we could do it!
- ☐ How do you want to celebrate this?
- ☐ How about you?
- ☐ How do you feel about including some chocolate?
- ☐ I could sense Farmani was leaning our way.
- ☐ I think you really persuaded him.

2) Select all the sentences that give an opinion.

- ☐ You weren't taken by surprise, were you?
- ☐ We haven't thought about that yet.
- ☐ Should I look into a caterer?
- ☐ I felt that as soon as he gave us the extension.
- ☐ That was a strong indication, if you ask me.
- ☐ I must say I like the idea.
- ☐ Of course!
- ☐ To be honest, you're good at that.
- ☐ I could be wrong, but we have some employees on a high protein diet, so we need meat as well.



Let's Practice!

Miranda wants to change the topic of the conversation. What does she say?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Write the correct words to complete the sentences. Read them aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Everyone's worked hard. O_____ t_____ n_____, how do you want to celebrate this?
2. B_____ t_____ w_____, what kind of diets do people follow?
3. Sounds complicated. B_____, we haven't mentioned dessert.
4. Oh t_____ r_____ me, we should get a cake!
5. S_____ o_____ sweets, I'll bring us some coffees before we spend some time discussing where to go from here.





Extension Activity

Let's plan a party.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Plan a small office party to celebrate a new achievement.
- Choose the type of party you want to have.
- Make a list of things you want to have at the party (for example: type of music, kind of food, location, etc.)
- Have a conversation with a partner about the type of party you want to have. Ask and exchange opinions.
- Interrupt your partner, change topics and get back to the topic when it is appropriate.
- When you are finished, make sure you have made all the decisions and arrangements for the party.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I plan a small office party.

☐ ☐

I choose the music, food and location for the party.

☐ ☐

I have a conversation with a partner about a party I will plan.

☐ ☐

I interrupt a conversation, change topics and return to a topic.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- luncheon** (noun): a formal lunch
e.g. We should plan a luncheon for when Peter gets back.
- caterer** (noun): a person or company whose job is to provide food and drinks at a business meeting or special occasion
e.g. Should I look into hiring a caterer?
- vegan** (noun): a person who does not eat any animal products such as meat, milk or eggs
e.g. There are some vegans in the company.
- vegetarian** (adjective): eating no meat or fish
e.g. I'm vegetarian and don't eat meat.
- gluten-free** (adjective): eating no foods that contain a sticky substance which is found in wheat flour
e.g. I'm on a gluten-free diet.
- high protein** (adjective): eating foods that contain substances your body needs in order to grow and remain strong
e.g. I think she's on a high protein diet so we need to.
- low-sodium** (adjective): eating foods that contain a small amount of salt
e.g. I'm on a low-sodium diet.
- low-fat** (adjective): eating foods that contain a small amount of oily substances
e.g. How do you feel about following a low-fat diet?





Learning Points

Changing Topics

In English, sometimes we need to interrupt people. This can be because we need to say something, express our opinion, or make a suggestion.

In a conversation, changing the topic is acceptable and perfectly normal. Once the other person has stopped speaking, you will need to return to the topic you were previously talking about.

Here are some common ways you can do this:

Changing the topic

- Speaking of ...
- By the way ...
- On that note ...
- Oh, that reminds me ...
- But ...

Examples:

- *"We should have a party to celebrate the new contract."*
- *"Absolutely. Speaking of parties, we need to find a good caterer."*





Learning Points

Giving and Exchanging Opinions

Conversations are far more interesting when people interact during the conversation. It is important to ask for others' opinions on a subject as well as giving your own.

Here are some ways you can ask for and give opinions:

Asking for Opinions

Always ask questions that encourage a response:

- What do you think about ... ?
- What do you think of ... ?
- How do you feel (about ...)?
- Should I ... ?
- How do you want to ... ?
- How about you?

Use tag questions

1. positive verb + negative tag

Use this when you think the other person will agree by saying "yes"

- You **were** taken by surprise, **weren't** you?

2. negative verb + positive tag

Use this when you think the other person will agree by saying "no"

- You **weren't** taken by surprise, **were** you?

Giving Opinions

When you give opinions, make your opinions less forceful by using neutral statements:

- I could ... (+ verb)
- This/That was ... (+ adjective + noun)
- I think ... (+ clause)
- I must say I ... (+ verb phrase)
- To be honest ... (+ clause)
- (clause) ... if you ask me.
- I could be wrong, but ... (+ clause)
- I felt that ... (+ clause)

Examples:

• **Jay:** "I'm happy we got the contract."

Mary: "You **were** taken by surprise, **weren't** you?"

Jay: "**I must say** that I was. **I thought** they would offer the contract to our competitor."

